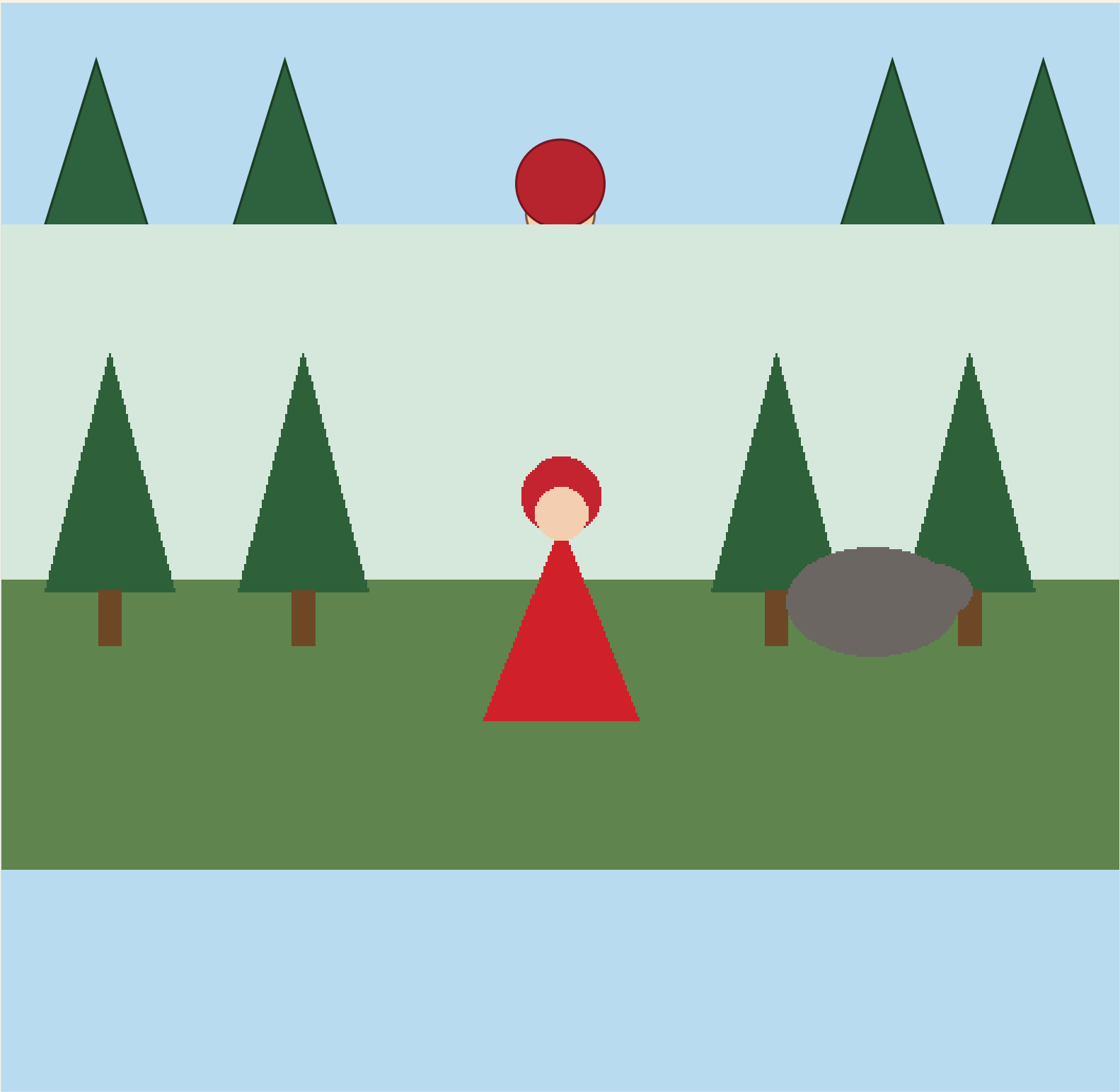
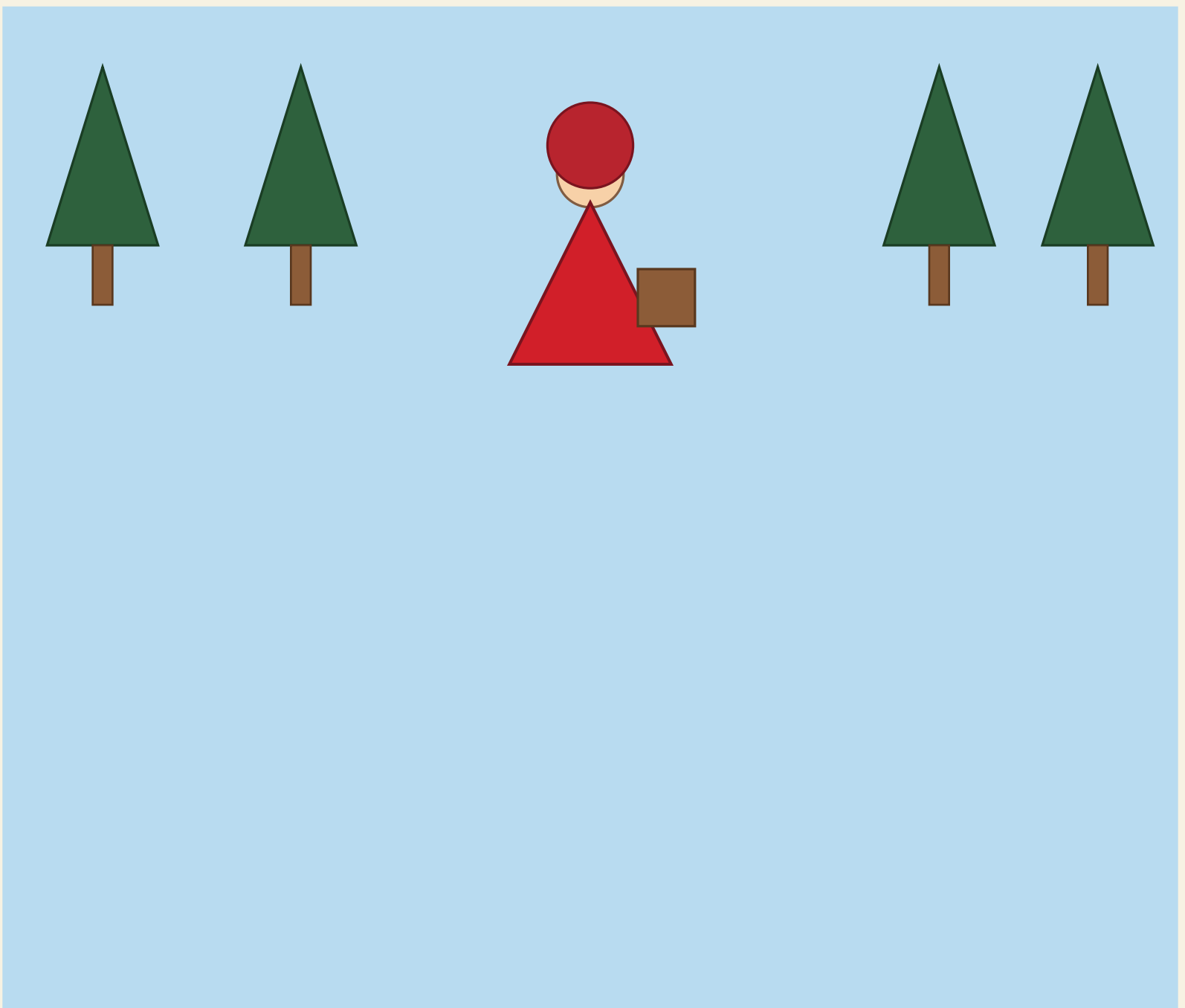


A public-domain tale · Brothers Grimm



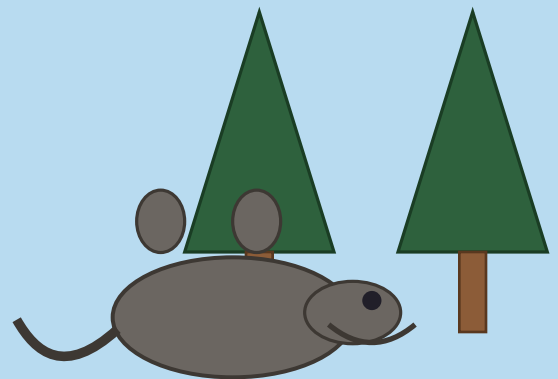
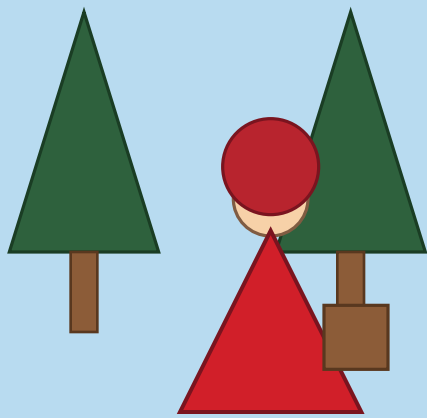
1. Into the woods

Once upon a time there was a sweet little girl whom everyone loved. Her grandmother had made her a little red riding hood, and because she wore it so often, she was called Little Red Riding Hood. One day her mother said, "Take this cake and bottle of wine to your grandmother, who is ill and weak. Go straight through the wood and do not leave the path." Little Red Riding Hood promised to obey, put on her hood, and set out with her basket through the tall green trees.



2. The wolf on the path

As she walked, a wolf came out of the forest. He wished to eat her, but dared not while woodcutters were near. So he spoke kindly: "Good day, Little Red Riding Hood. Where are you going so early?" She told him of her grandmother. The wolf thought, "What a tender young creature? she will taste better than the old woman." He said, "See how the flowers bloom! Why not gather a nosegay for your grandmother?" The child left the path and wandered among the blossoms while the wolf ran straight to the grandmother's house.



3. At grandmother's door

The wolf knocked at the cottage door. When the grandmother opened it, he sprang upon her and swallowed her whole. Then he put on her nightcap, drew the curtains, and lay down in her bed. Presently Little Red Riding Hood arrived and wondered why the door stood open. She went to the bed and said, "Oh, Grandmother, what big ears you have!" "The better to hear you with," said the wolf. "What big eyes you have!" "The better to see you with." "What big teeth you have!" "The better to eat you with!" And with that the wolf leaped from the bed.



4. The woodcutter's rescue

A passing woodcutter heard the cry and ran into the cottage with his axe. He struck the wolf so that he opened his mouth and let the child spring out. Then the woodcutter cut open the sleeping wolf, and the grandmother stepped out alive and unharmed. Little Red Riding Hood fetched great stones, which they put inside the wolf; when he woke he tried to flee, but the stones were so heavy that he fell down dead. The grandmother ate the cake and drank the wine, and Little Red Riding Hood thought, "I will never again leave the path and run into the wood when my mother has forbidden it."

